

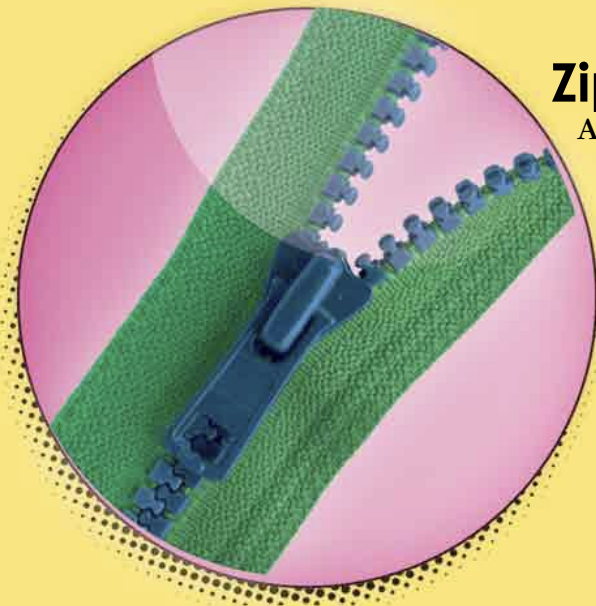
## Snaps

If you were an actor with a *quick change* between scenes in the 1800s, you might use some of these newly invented fasteners, which made whipping costumes **on and off** easy. German Heribert Bauer's 1885 snaps were improved by American Jack Weil during the 1900s, who added them to denim shirts in place of buttons—giving the finishing touch to the **COWBOY LOOK**.



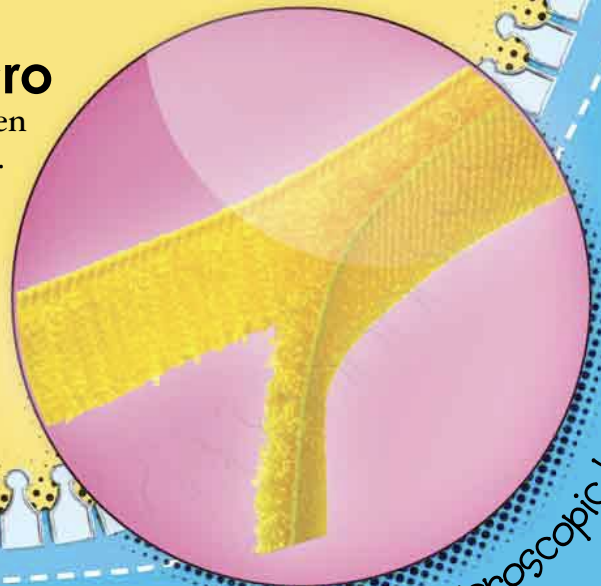
## Zipper

American Whitcomb Judson wanted to get his **BOOTS** on and off quicker, so in 1893 he invented a fastener that hooked them up with one pull, using a sliding device on a row of clasps. Judson's fastener tended to come undone, but *Gideon Sundback* developed a version that used metal teeth on flexible tape. It was used as the fastener for a boot called the Zipper, and **the name stuck**.



## Velcro

**George de Mestral** got the idea for Velcro when he saw burdock burrs sticking to his dog's coat. When he looked at them through a microscope, he saw that the burrs were covered in tiny hooks that attached to loops in the dog's fur. He developed **VELCRO** so that one side was covered in tiny hooks, and the other in tiny loops. The name comes from the French *velours croché*, or "hooked velvet."



Velcro works like microscopic hooks and eyes.

